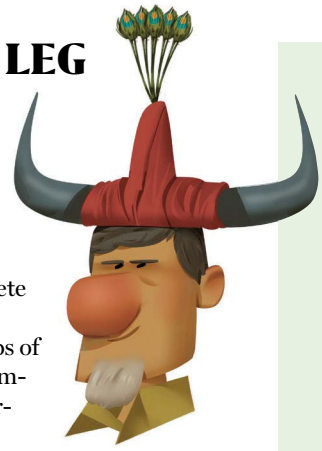
NAIDU SHAKES A LEG



Andhra Pradesh CM **N. Chandrababu Naidu**, better known for his staid demeanour, briefly broke character on August 9 as he joined the dancers at a World Tribal Day event in Vijayawada. Wearing traditional headgear complete with horns and bird feathers, Naidu beat a drum and even tried a few steps of Dhimsa, the folk dance of tribal communities along the Andhra-Odisha border. The performance came just days after the state organised a Guinness record-setting Dhimsa dance at the inauguration of Vizag International Airport at Bhogapuram on August 1. More than 13,000 tribal women and girl students participated in the 'largest Dhimsa dance' then.



MIDNIGHT PLOT

Cricketer **Rishabh Pant's** late-night appeal to Uttarakhand CM **Pushkar Singh Dhami** for land to build a house in his 'home state' produced an unusually entertaining exchange. At 12.46 am on August 8, Pant tagged Dhami on X, saying he had been trying for three years and sought the government's help in finding a suitable plot. By morning, Dhami had responded in earnest, calling Pant Uttarakhand's pride and directing officials to contact him. A midnight plea had turned into a government assurance by breakfast.

STUTTER DISGRACE



Uttar Pradesh basic education minister **Sandeep Singh** has landed in a social media storm after a video of him struggling to read a Hindi passage in the assembly went viral. In the clip, Singh falters over words, and appears to struggle to complete the passage. The video quickly drew ridicule online, with viewers questioning how he could be in charge of the education portfolio. Opposition leaders, too, seized on it to target the BJP government over the state of school education in UP. Sandeep, though, seems unaffected. He is, after all, the grandson of late CM Kalyan Singh and son of BJP MP Rajveer Singh.

Kaushik Deka* with *Ashish Misra, Amitabh Srivastava, Prasad Nichenametla* and *Avaneesh Mishra

ECO WATCH

INDIA'S ELECTRICITY SUPPLY STILL LOW ON CLEAN POWER

By **Jumana Shah**

India has crossed a milestone it had promised for 2030. In late July, the government informed Parliament that non-fossil sources made up 54.2 per cent of the country's installed electricity capacity. Of the total 548.9 GW, clean sources account for 297.4 GW. Solar alone contributes 162.2 GW, followed by wind (57.4 GW) and large hydro (52.1 GW).



The government also said the 'emissions intensity' of India's GDP fell 37.4 per cent by 2022 (from 2005 levels), against a 2030 target of 45 per cent.

But installed capacity is only the ability to make power. It is not the power actually produced and utilised. Central Electricity Authority (CEA) figures for April to June 2026 show that thermal plants, mostly coal, produced 70.3 per cent of India's electricity. All non-fossil sources together produced 29.5 per cent. The reason: a coal plant can run day and night while a solar panel works only when the sun shines.

The gap shows up most sharply when demand peaks. On May 21 this year, India hit an all-time peak of 270.8 GW. Renewables, including hydro, met 34 per cent of it. The remaining 66 per cent came from coal, gas and nuclear. Closing that gap needs storage, which India has very little. Batteries in operation stood at 8.7 GWh at the end of June, roughly a quarter of what the National Electricity Plan says the country needs by March 2027. Rating agency ICRA also found that a third of the 54.8 GW of recently commissioned renewable capacity is being evacuated on temporary grid access, leading to curtailment in Gujarat and Rajasthan. The easier bit of installing RE capacity is done. Now comes the tough part.